

Public Companies: Fintech

Payment rails, processors, neobanks, BNPL, and wealth platforms -- kept distinct from traditional banking and mostly distinct from crypto

Context: 2026 is the year the fintech IPO drought ended. Chime (CHYM) and Klarna (KLAR) both listed in the second half of 2025 after a two-year freeze, re-establishing public comps for an entire category of late-stage private fintechs. The line with crypto is intentionally kept fuzzy here, not hard -- Circle, Coinbase, and other crypto-native names are covered in your dedicated Crypto list, but a few names below (Robinhood, PayPal) genuinely straddle both and are flagged where relevant.

1. Payment Networks & Card Rails

Company	Ticker	Role	Recent Signal (2026)
Visa	V	Dominant global card payment network	Piloting stablecoin settlement on its network and a US debit partnership with Klarna, extending its rails into newer fintech categories
Mastercard	MA	Second major global card payment network	Continues expanding into open banking, tokenization, and stablecoin-adjacent settlement infrastructure
American Express	AXP	Closed-loop card network and card-issuing bank; belongs in both this list and Traditional Banking	Continues to benefit from affluent-consumer spending resilience even as mass-market discretionary spend softens

2. Payment Processors & Core Financial Infrastructure

The B2B plumbing layer -- processing transactions and providing core technology for banks and merchants. Went through major consolidation in early 2026.

Company	Ticker	Role	Recent Signal (2026)
Fiserv	FISV	Core banking technology, card processing, and the Clover merchant platform	Stock lost 40%+ of value in Oct 2025 after weak earnings and Clover fee complaints; switched listing back to Nasdaq (Nov 2025) and ticker back to FISV; 2026 guidance of \$8-\$8.30 EPS disappointed
Global Payments	GPN	Merchant acquiring and payments technology	Completed ~\$24B acquisition of Worldpay from GTCR/FIS while divesting its Issuer Solutions (TSYS) business to FIS in a simultaneous three-way transaction, becoming a "pure-play merchant solutions business"
FIS	FIS	Banking and payments technology across the full "money lifecycle"	Completed acquisition of Global Payments' Issuer Solutions (TSYS) for \$13.5B while selling its remaining Worldpay stake; ~4% dividend yield, steadier growth profile than Fiserv
PayPal	PYPL	Digital wallet and checkout; also issues its own PYUSD stablecoin (crosses into crypto)	Continues expanding stablecoin and crypto checkout functionality; see also Crypto list

Block (formerly Square)	XYZ	Cash App and Square merchant ecosystem; also crosses into crypto via Cash App Bitcoin	Dual exposure to consumer fintech and small-merchant payments; see also Crypto list
Marqeta	MQ	Card issuing infrastructure/API platform used by Klarna, Cash App, and other fintechs	Named as embedding infrastructure for Klarna's card expansion

3. Neobanks & Digital Banking

Two anchor 2025-2026 IPOs re-opened this category to public markets after a two-year drought.

Company	Ticker	Role	Recent Signal (2026)
Chime Financial	CHYM	America's largest neobank by users; fee-free banking via interchange revenue, not lending	IPO'd June 2025, largest-ever US neobank listing (~\$864M raised); 8.6M active members; shares surged 59% on debut before settling; the 'cleaner, lower-risk' neobank story since it takes minimal credit risk
SoFi Technologies	SOFI	Digital personal finance platform: lending, mortgages, investing, banking	Named among top 2026 bank-adjacent stocks to watch; makes most of its money from net interest income, unlike Chime
Nu Holdings (Nubank)	NU	Largest neobank by market cap globally; 125M+ customers across Brazil, Mexico, Colombia	Received conditional approval for a US banking license (Jan 2026), pursuing a full charter rather than a sponsor-bank partnership -- the strongest current proof point that the neobank model scales to profitability

4. Buy Now, Pay Later (BNPL)

No longer just a checkout feature -- both leaders are explicitly building toward full-spectrum consumer banking.

Company	Ticker	Role	Recent Signal (2026)
Affirm Holdings	AFRM	BNPL and point-of-sale lending, actively expanding into Europe and full consumer banking	Q4 GMV of \$1.2B, up 132% YoY; applied to the FDIC to expand beyond its existing Cross River Bank savings account; partnership with Fiserv embeds BNPL into debit/banking
Klarna Group	KLAR	Swedish BNPL and shopping platform; 150M+ users, 500K+ merchants	Listed on NYSE Sept 2025 at a \$15B valuation (down sharply from a \$46B 2021 peak) after a 5-month delay; 37% YoY GMV growth; piloting a US debit offering via Visa; leaned hard into AI cost-cutting (claims its AI agent handles 700 FTE-equivalent workload)

5. Wealth & Trading Platforms

Company	Ticker	Role	Recent Signal (2026)
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Robinhood	HOOD	Retail brokerage spanning equities, options, and crypto trading; crosses meaningfully into the Crypto list	Up ~185-190% in 2025 on retail trading resurgence; high-margin Gold subscription cited as valuation support (see also Crypto list)
Interactive Brokers	IBKR	Global electronic brokerage for retail and institutional traders	Lower-profile but structurally profitable alternative to Robinhood with broader international/institutional exposure

Private Fintechs Worth Watching (Pending IPOs)

- **Stripe** (\$170B valuation) — filed a confidential S-1 in Feb 2026 and is currently in IPO roadshow; the largest pure payments-infrastructure IPO candidate outstanding.
- **Revolut** (\$75B valuation) — Europe's most valuable fintech, holds a UK banking license, preparing for a 2026 listing; also has crypto/stock trading exposure.
- **Plaid, Brex, Ramp** — B2B financial infrastructure and spend-management platforms still private; Capital One notably acquired Brex's card program in 2026, a sign of bank/fintech consolidation happening even pre-IPO.
- **Gusto** — payroll/HR fintech serving 300K+ SMBs; a distinct embedded-finance category not directly covered above.

Categories Worth Adding

- **InsurTech** — Lemonade (LMND) and similar AI-driven insurance platforms form a distinct vertical not covered above.
- **B2B Embedded Finance / Spend Management** — the Brex/Ramp/Gusto category above is large enough to warrant its own dedicated pass once more of these names go public.
- **Cross-Border Payments & Remittances** — Wise and similar transparent-fee money-transfer platforms are a distinct category from domestic payment rails.

Generated July 10, 2026. This is a disjoint reference set, not a ranked or filtered list.